Digital Literacy Portfolio Report

Name: Samir Mansuri
Reg No.: 25BCE11144
Branch: CSE Core
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Course Title: Digital Literacy

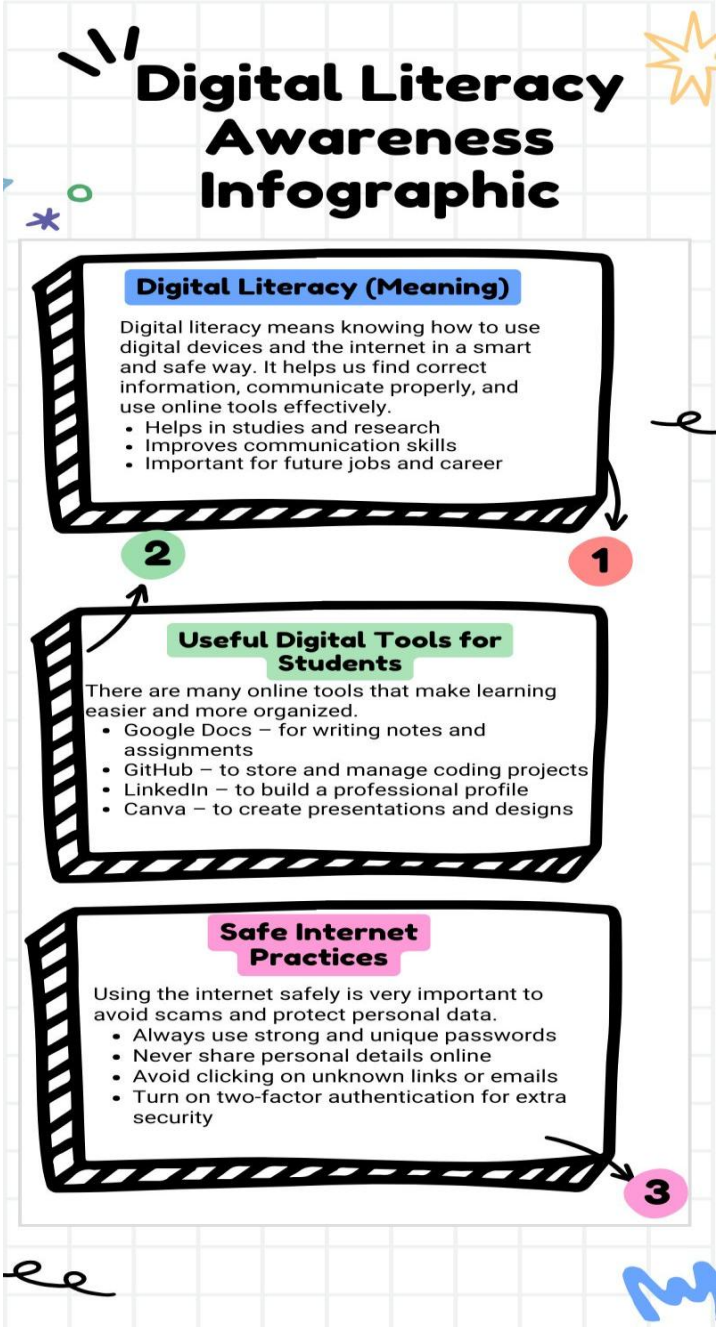
Introduction

Honestly, before this project I never really thought about "digital literacy" as a proper skill. I just assumed that since I use my phone and laptop every day, I already know how to use the internet. But going through this project made me realise there's a big difference between casually scrolling online and actually being digitally literate.

This project is structured around five tasks, each covering a different area — from creating an infographic and setting up professional profiles, to learning coding platforms, writing formal emails, and understanding cybercrime. The whole idea is that we're supposed to act as Student Digital Ambassadors, which honestly felt a bit formal at first, but as I worked through each task it started making sense. If you know these things, you genuinely can help people around you navigate the digital world better.

Each task pushed me to do something I hadn't done properly before, and I've tried to document not just what I did but also what I actually learned from it.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic



I created an infographic on digital literacy awareness using Canva for this assignment. I chose Canva because it's completely browser-based, free, and flexible enough to produce structured content without requiring any prior graphic design experience.

Each of the three sections that make up my infographic covers a distinct subject. The definition of digital literacy is explained in the first section. I defined it as the ability to use digital devices

and the internet safely and intelligently, covering three useful advantages: aiding in research and studies, enhancing communication skills, and preparing for future careers. Since first-year students, not faculty, are the intended audience, I kept the definition straightforward.

The second section lists useful digital tools for students — Google Docs for notes and assignments, GitHub for managing coding projects, LinkedIn for building a professional presence, and Canva itself for creating presentations and designs. I chose these four specifically because they are tools we are likely to actually use during our B.Tech, not just theoretical examples.

The third section covers safe internet practices — using strong and unique passwords, not sharing personal details online, avoiding unknown links or emails, and enabling two-factor authentication. These felt the most immediately actionable for someone starting college life.

The part I found genuinely difficult was fitting everything into one page without it looking cluttered. I had more points written initially but had to cut them down, which taught me that good design is as much about removing things as it is about adding them.I had more points written initially but had to cut them down, which taught me that good design is as much about removing things as it is about adding them.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For this task I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Honestly these three felt like the most practical choices for a CSE student rather than just picking any three platforms randomly.

GitHub I had heard about before but never actually used properly. It's where developers store their code and manage projects — kind of like Google Drive but specifically built for programming work. I set up my profile README with my name, branch, year and what I want to learn. It looks pretty empty right now and I'm okay with that — the whole point is that it grows as I build more things over the next four years. Looks pretty empty right now and I'm okay with that — the whole point is that it grows as I build more things over the next four years.

LinkedIn was already up but I had not used it seriously before. The professional network where recruiters, companies and other professionals connect with students. I actually filled in my Education section correctly this time. I will begin using it more frequently, in second or third year when internship hunting actually starts.

I had never heard of Kaggle before, let alone used it. After registering I noticed that mostly it is a platform for data science and machine learning — competitions, datasets, training notebooks. It's not something I need heavily right now but since ML is part of our curriculum later, having the account ready made sense.

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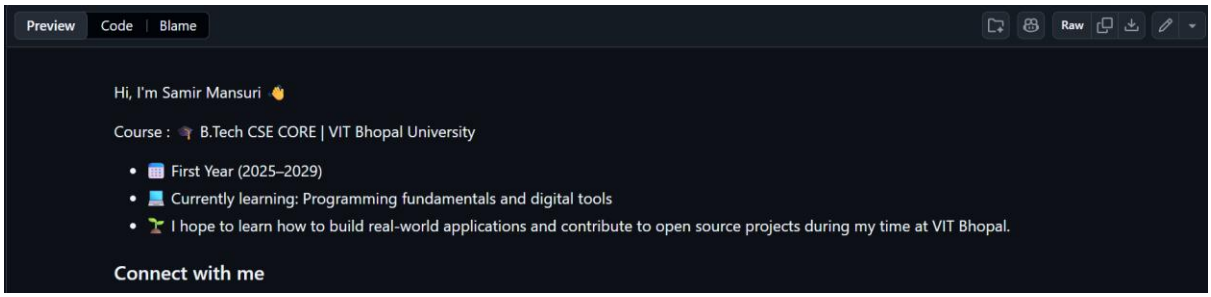
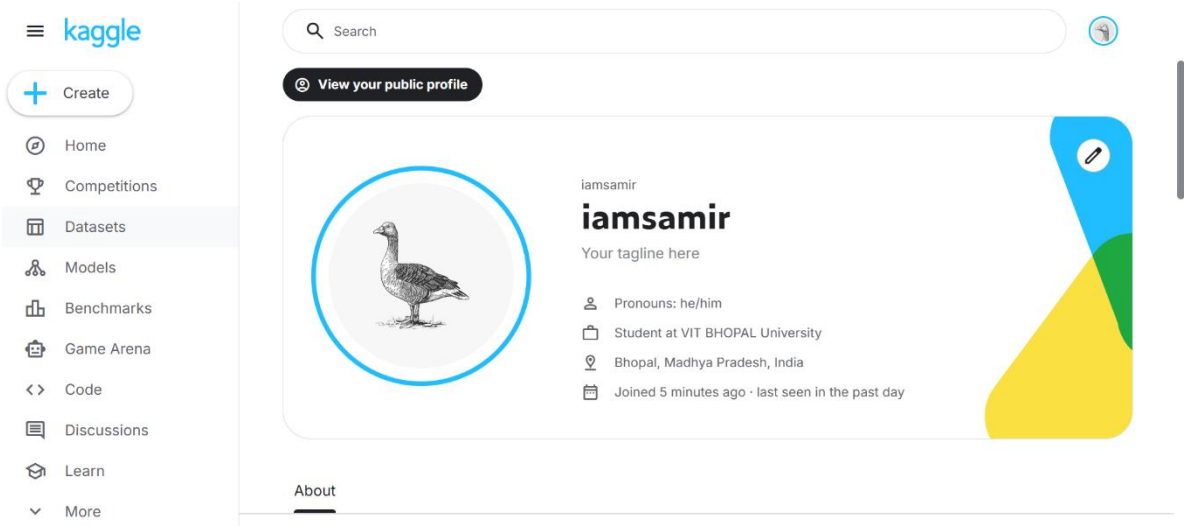


Linkedin:

Kaggle:



Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

All in all, for this task I used up two platforms and truthfully each were more helpful than I thought heading into it.

The first one was HackerRank. I had seen the name popping up on senior students' LinkedIn profiles but never actually tried it myself. I registered myself and solved two beginner-level Python problems. The puzzles themselves were not difficult at all but that is not the thing I remember. What I found really exciting was the way the platform assesses your code — you hit submit, and within seconds you are told whether your solution has passed or failed multiple test cases that run automatically behind the scenes. That's a very different thing than running your code once on your laptop and hoping for the best.

The second platform was Google Forms where I built a five question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. Making the questions was actually trickier than I thought

— you have to word things clearly enough that someone who doesn't know the answer can't just guess from how the question is phrased.

HackerRank I plan to use regularly for Python practice going forward. Google Forms will probably come in handy for group projects and collecting feedback without making things complicated.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

There was a situation I came across where a student from a private engineering college posted a frustrated comment on LinkedIn publicly calling out a company after a campus placement drive, saying the process was unfair and the interviewers were rude. He named the company directly in the post.

Within a day the post had been shared widely. The company's HR team saw it and responded by removing that college from their campus recruitment list entirely for the following year. Hundreds of students lost an opportunity because of one person's impulsive post on what they probably didn't fully think of as a professional platform in that moment.

What could have been done differently is simple — if you have a genuine complaint, raise it privately through proper channels. LinkedIn is not a place to vent. Once something is posted publicly it is completely out of your control.

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Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

Honestly what surprised me most while working on this task was how low-tech most of these scams actually are. I always assumed cybercrime involved serious hacking — someone breaking into systems or writing complex code. But UPI fraud doesn't need any of that. It just needs one person who doesn't fully understand what a collect request does and another person who does. That gap in knowledge is the entire attack.

The part that genuinely got to me was reading about how many college students fall for scholarship and cashback scams specifically because they're already hoping for financial support. The scammers know exactly who to target and what to say.

The one habit I'm personally changing is simple — I will never approve any UPI request from an unknown number regardless of what the message says. If money is coming to me I don't need to do anything. That's it.

Conclusion

This project turned out to be more useful than I expected going in. I came in thinking it would just be a formality — create some accounts, make a design, submit. But each task ended up teaching me something I actually didn't know before. Setting up GitHub made me realise how early you need to start building a digital presence. The cybercrime task genuinely changed how I look at UPI notifications. Writing professional emails made me realise I'd been doing it wrong for a while.

If I'm being honest the biggest takeaway isn't any single task — it's that being digitally literate isn't about knowing how to use apps. It's about knowing how to use them responsibly, safely and in a way that actually works in your favour long term.

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